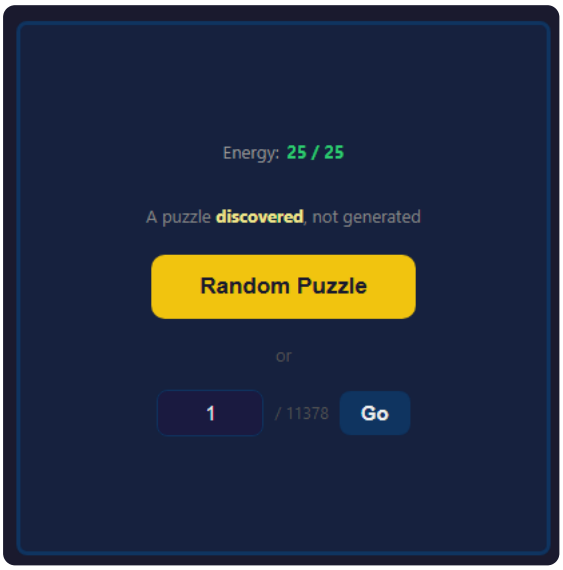
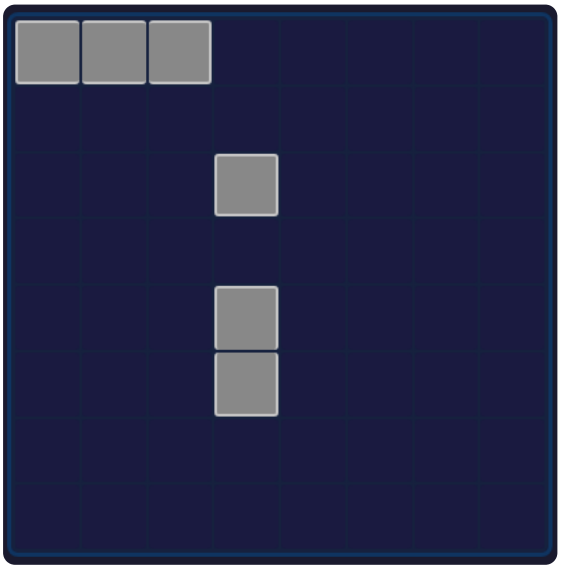
How to Play Octile

Quick Start



1. Open the game — the **welcome panel** appears
2. Tap **Random Puzzle** or enter a puzzle number and tap **Go**
3. **Drag** tiles from the piece tray onto the 8×8 board (or tap to select, then tap a cell)
4. Fill every empty cell — no overlaps, no gaps
5. Board complete? You win!

The Board

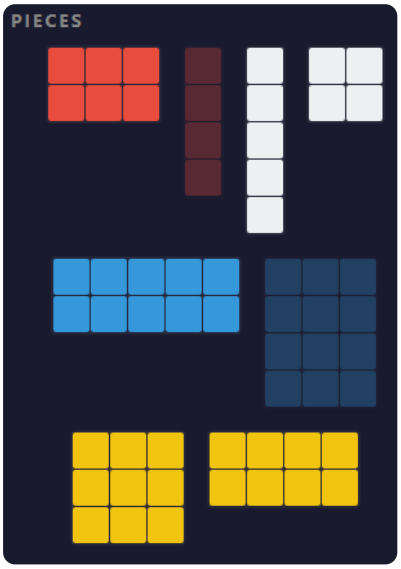


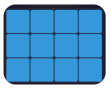
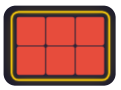
- **8×8 grid** — 64 cells total
- **3 grey tiles** are pre-placed and cannot be moved — they define the puzzle
- **8 colored tiles** sit in the piece tray — these are yours to arrange

The 11 Tiles

Grey (pre-placed, 6 cells total): 1×1, 1×2, 1×3

Player tiles (58 cells total):



Tile	Size	Color	Preview
3×4	12 cells	Blue	
2×5	10 cells	Blue	
3×3	9 cells	Yellow	
2×4	8 cells	Yellow	
2×3	6 cells	Red	
1×5	5 cells	White	
1×4	4 cells	Red	
2×2	4 cells	White	

Grey + Player = **64 cells** (the entire board).

Controls

Place a Tile

- **Drag & drop** — drag a tile from the piece tray and drop it onto the board
- **Tap to place** — tap a tile to select it (yellow highlight), then tap an empty cell on the board

Rotate a Tile

- **Tap** an already-selected tile again to rotate it 90°
- Repeat to cycle through orientations

Remove a Tile

- **Drag** a placed tile off the board to return it to the tray
- Or **tap** a placed tile on the board to pick it back up

Navigation

Control	Action
# + **Go**	Jump to a specific puzzle (1–11,378)
Random	Load a random puzzle
Hint	Reveal the correct position of one unplaced tile

Energy System

Each puzzle costs energy. Solve faster to spend less.

Solve Time	Energy Cost
≤ 60 seconds	1
≤ 2 minutes	2
≤ 3 minutes	3
≤ 5 minutes	4
> 5 minutes	5

- You start with **25 energy points**
- Energy **regenerates progressively** over **4 hours** back to 25
- Energy is deducted **after** you solve a puzzle, not when you start one
- You need at least **1 energy** to start a new puzzle
- Tap the ⚡ **energy display** in the header to see your full energy status and recovery timer

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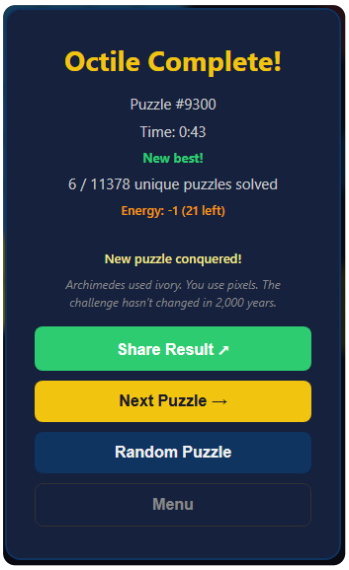
Hints

- Tap the **Hint** button to reveal one unplaced tile's correct position
- The correct cells flash briefly on the board
- **3 hints per puzzle** maximum
- Hints do not affect your solve time or energy cost
- Solving without hints earns the **Pure Logic** achievement

Timer

- The timer is **lazy** — it only starts when you place your first tile
- Browsing the welcome panel or rotating tiles in the tray does not start the clock
- Your best time per puzzle is saved automatically

Win Screen



When you fill the board correctly:

- **Confetti** celebration
- **Solve time** and personal best comparison
- **Unique progress** — how many of the 11,378 puzzles you've completed
- **Energy cost** for this solve
- **Newly earned badges** (if any)
- **"Did You Know?"** — a rotating fun fact about Octile or its history
- **Motivational messages** for milestones, speed achievements, and personal bests

After winning, you can:

- **Share Result** — sends a screenshot of your completed board + puzzle link via Web Share API (or copies to clipboard)
- **Next Puzzle** — load the next puzzle in sequence
- **Random Puzzle** — load a random puzzle
- **Menu** — return to the welcome panel

Sharing

- **During gameplay** — tap the share button (↗️) to share a link to the current puzzle
- **On the win screen** — tap **Share Result** to share a board screenshot with your time
- Shared links use the `?p=N` format, so recipients jump directly to that puzzle

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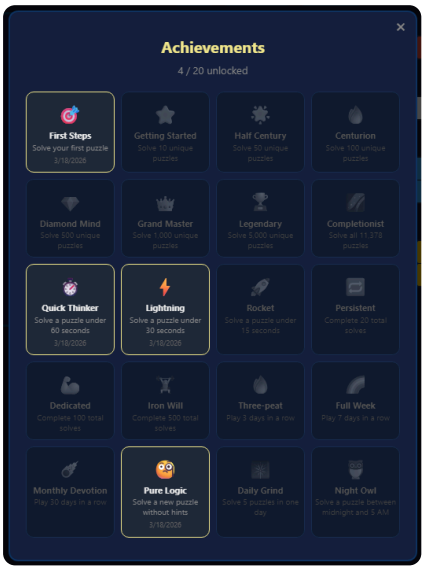
Achievements

Octile has **20 badges** across 5 categories. Tap the trophy button in the header to view your collection.



Milestones (unique puzzles solved)

Badge	Name	Requirement
🎯	First Steps	Solve 1 puzzle
⭐	Getting Started	Solve 10 unique puzzles
🌟	Half Century	Solve 50 unique puzzles
🔥	Centurion	Solve 100 unique puzzles
💎	Diamond Mind	Solve 500 unique puzzles
👑	Grand Master	Solve 1,000 unique puzzles
🏆	Legendary	Solve 5,000 unique puzzles
🌌	Completionist	Solve all 11,378 puzzles

Speed

Badge	Name	Requirement
⏱️	Quick Thinker	Solve under 60 seconds
⚡	Lightning	Solve under 30 seconds
🚀	Rocket	Solve under 15 seconds

Dedication (total solves, including re-solves)

Badge	Name	Requirement
🔁	Persistent	20 total solves
💪	Dedicated	100 total solves
🏋️	Iron Will	500 total solves

Streak (consecutive days)

Badge	Name	Requirement
🔥	Three-peat	3 days in a row
🌈	Full Week	7 days in a row
☄️	Monthly Devotion	30 days in a row

Special

Badge	Name	Requirement
🤔	Pure Logic	Solve a new puzzle without hints
🎆	Daily Grind	Solve 5 puzzles in one day
🦉	Night Owl	Solve a puzzle between midnight and 5 AM

Deep Links

You can link directly to any puzzle using URL parameters:

```
https://mtaleon.github.io/octile/?p=42
```

This skips the splash screen and welcome panel, loading puzzle #42 immediately.

Tips & Strategy

- **Start with the largest tile** (3×4, 12 cells) — it has the fewest possible positions
- **Corner and edge placements** are more constrained — use them to your advantage
- **Work from constraints** — fill the tightest spaces first
- **Use hints wisely** — you only get 3 per puzzle
- **Every puzzle is solvable** — if you're stuck, rethink your approach rather than restarting
- **Solve quickly** to conserve energy — under 60 seconds costs only 1 point

FAQ

Q: Are puzzles randomly generated? No. All 11,378 puzzles are discovered through exhaustive mathematical search and verified under D4 symmetry (rotations and reflections). Every puzzle is unique.

Q: Can a puzzle be unsolvable? No. Every puzzle has been verified to have at least one valid solution.

Q: What does D4 symmetry mean? If you rotate or flip a puzzle, it's considered the same puzzle. This ensures no duplicates exist in the 11,378 set.

Q: Does the game work offline? Yes. Octile is a PWA (Progressive Web App). Once loaded, it works offline. You can also install it to your home screen.

Q: How do I change the language? Tap the **文 / EN** button in the top-left corner. The game auto-detects your browser locale on first visit.

Q: What happens when I run out of energy? You cannot start a new puzzle until at least 1 point recovers. Energy regenerates continuously — full recovery takes 4 hours from zero.